

PHYLLOSILICATES



PREHNITE

Orthorhombic
H 6–6½ • SG 2.8–2.95
Prehnite is a hydrous silicate of calcium and aluminium. It occurs in cavities in basalt.

spherical mass
of radiating
crystals



OKENITE

Triclinic • H 4½–5 • SG 2.28–2.33
This hydrated calcium silicate has fibrous or blade-like crystals, usually white or tinted blue or yellow. It occurs in basalt.

tabular
crystal



MUSCOVITE

Monoclinic
H 2½ • SG 2.77–2.88
Muscovite, or white mica, is a potassium aluminium aluminosilicate hydroxide, with fluorine. It is very common in metamorphic rocks and granite.



prismatic
crystal

PETALITE
Monoclinic
H 6½ • SG 2.41–2.42
Petalite is a lithium aluminium silicate. Crystals are usually grey-white and in aggregates. It is mined for lithium.



CAVANSITE

Orthorhombic • H 3–4 • SG 2.21–2.31
Cavansite is a hydrated calcium vanadium silicate. It is blue or greenish blue, and occurs in cavities in basalt.

PHLOGOPITE
Monoclinic
H 2–3 • SG 2.78–2.85
The colourless, yellow, or brown mica phlogopite is a potassium magnesium aluminosilicate hydroxide.



spherical crystal
aggregate



typical blue
colouring

SEPIOLITE

Orthorhombic • H 2 • SG 2–2.2
This pale-coloured clay mineral, a hydrous magnesium silicate, usually occurs as earthy masses in altered rocks. It is used for ornamental carving.



LEPIDOLITE

Monoclinic • H 2½–3½ • SG 2.80–2.9
Lepidolite is the term used for mica minerals that are potassium lithium aluminium aluminosilicate hydroxides, with fluorine.



tabular lepidolite
crystal



CLINOCHLORE

Monoclinic
H 2–2½ • SG 2.6–3.02
This hydrous silicate of iron, magnesium, and aluminium forms as green tabular crystals. It occurs in a variety of rock types.

radiating
crystal groups



TECTOSILICATES



SMOKY QUARTZ

Trigonal • H 7 • SG 2.65
Smoky quartz is a brown variety of quartz, a silicon dioxide. It occurs in igneous rocks and hydrothermal veins.



ROSE QUARTZ

Trigonal • H 7 • SG 2.65
Rose quartz is a prized, translucent pink variety of quartz. Crystals are very rare; it usually has a massive habit.



MILKY QUARTZ

Trigonal
H 7 • SG 2.65
This very common, milky white variety of quartz occurs in all types of rocks and in hydrothermal veins.



CITRINE

Trigonal
H 7 • SG 2.65
Citrine is a yellow to brownish variety of quartz. It resembles topaz and is often used as a gemstone.



AMETHYST

Trigonal
H 7 • SG 2.65
Amethyst is a purple variety of quartz, prized since ancient times. It is found in hydrothermal veins and in lava cavities.